

Delaware County Drainage Board Meeting July 8th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2zxAJcHF9SY
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Delaware County Drainage Board Meeting Report

Meeting Date: July 8

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the July 8th Delaware County Drainage Board meeting at timestamp [00:08:21](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Whitehead, Mr. Nelson (also referred to as Mr. Rian / Mr. Ryan in roll calls), Mr. Christie, Mr. Ball (or Buffalo), and Mr. Hamilton (or similar commissioners/board members noted across roll calls).
 - **Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Noted as the board president/chair conducting roll calls and proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** [00:08:23](#) The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.

- **Approval of Minutes:** 00:08:56 Approval of the June meeting minutes (noted as corrected from an agenda titling error). **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (followed by a formal roll call record where members voted Yes).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:09:46 Tabled Business: A. McConnell Reconstruction (Banning Engineering Report)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor / Joe Miller (Banning Engineering).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed untabling the A. McConnell reconstruction report to move it to the open house section of the agenda. The broader project involves drainage challenges, aging infrastructure dating back to the 1890s, and previous reconstructions in the 1970s and 2009.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Removed from the table and moved to open discussion / open house section. (Later in the meeting at 01:34:40, a motion was made and seconded to table further action on this item until the next meeting). **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:10:18 Tabled Business: Hog Creek Reconstruction**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor / Tom / Mr. Whitehead / David How.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed keeping Hog Creek reconstruction tabled because prominent landowners are still deciding how to proceed. Landowners and the highway department (Mr. Hbert / Tommy) noted that incremental improvements and culvert work on 700 East might address local issues without requiring a full expensive reconstruction.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** 01:08:41 Motion to remove from the table and close the issue. **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (all ayes).
- **00:18:59 Tabled Business: Chris Townsen / Culvert Pipe Issue**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor / Chris Townsen.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed an undersized, poorly designed single-wall 8-inch tile/French drain behind Morrison Woods that lacked a proper crossover culvert for farming access. Chris Townsen offered to install a 4-foot replacement pipe free of charge and assume future maintenance responsibility via a bridge/crossing agreement, while the drainage board agreed to cover the material cost of the pipe (\$1,560).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Chris Townsen explained the history and offered to perform the labor.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to provide approximately \$1,600 for the purchase of the culvert pipe, with Townsen performing the installation and maintenance. **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (all ayes).
- **00:27:03 New Business: Town of Selma Open Ditch Maintenance**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor / Bruce (Selma town board representative).
- **Deliberation Summary:** The town of Selma installed a large open ditch draining the eastern part of Selma that now needs debris clearing (estimated at \$10,000–\$12,000) and placement on a spray program. Most of the ditch lies outside municipal boundaries. The board discussed legal avenues for a petition (requiring affected landowner agreement) and ensuring the county does not take on private connections outside the scope.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table for further discussion and research until the next meeting. **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (all ayes).
- **00:36:50 New Business: Welsh Regulated Drain / Williams Ditch (400 West & 700 South)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor / Joe / David How / Mitch Swingley / JB Chapman.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed standing water, aging infrastructure, and blockages around 400 West and 700 South (Welsh/Williams Ditch watershed). Landowners testified that drainage has progressively worsened over the decades, causing agricultural flooding and impacting farm fields. The surveyor noted minor debris clearing and dipping might fall below the quote threshold, while a full reconstruction would be costly.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - *David How* ([01:35] / [041:35]): Noted the massive area drained and that Williams ditch needs dredging.
 - *Mitch Swingley* ([042:55]): Shared lifelong observations of worsening water stagnation and field flooding.
 - *JB Chapman* ([046:35]): Recommended clearing one side of the ditch, dipping it out step-by-step, and noted Henry County's watershed fund model.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** No immediate formal board action required; the surveyor will investigate and pursue minor repairs/quotes if under the threshold.
- **00:54:07 Old Business: Reactor Ditch Reconstruction Petition**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor / Cody Light and petitioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Petition to reconstruct the Reactor Ditch (745 acres, 65 parcels, originally installed in 1903). The board reviewed three alternatives presented by Banning Engineering: (1) Upsizing outlet tiles (costing over \$400,000 / ~\$624/acre), (2) Repairing the 15-inch submain to stop sinkholes (~\$150,000 / ~\$11/acre), and (3) Enhancing the grass waterway near Cowan Road (~\$300,000). Public safety concerns regarding road flooding on 400 South were raised.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - *Chris Daniel* (01:21:33): Waynewood resident noting residual sinkholes but acknowledging recent improvements.
 - *David How* (01:24:17): Noted topography challenges for grass waterways and supported exploring new tiling.

- *Steven Vand* (01:27:37): Highlighted public safety hazards of 4–6 inches of water and 12-inch deep field debris washing across 400 South during heavy rains.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table further action until the next meeting pending landowner outreach and regulatory review. **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (all ayes).
- 01:03:34 **Approval of Maintenance Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Surveyor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine review of maintenance claims, including a minor township correction noted by a board member for a JJC work order (changing Liberty Township to Monroe Township).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve maintenance claims as corrected. **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (all ayes).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:25:15 **Andrew Schwin** (McCain Brothers Excavation & Drainage): Formally introduced his company, a qualified contractor with Delaware County since November 2025, specializing in agricultural drainage, tile installation (3" to 36"), open ditch maintenance, and dredging. Distributed informational handouts.
- *(Note: Additional citizen testimony regarding specific agenda items was integrated into Section 4 under public hearings/item inputs).*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Reminder regarding the upcoming Farm Bureau Drainage School on July 26th (with county coverage offered for members/staff).
 - Mention of the upcoming Delaware County Fair starting around July 11th.
 - Brief mention of an upcoming 14-month county zoning ordinance rewrite led by the planning commission.
- **Adjournment:** 01:35:00 Having no further business, a motion for adjournment was made and approved by voice vote.